

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
FOR THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA

JOSEPH KIRCHNER,

Plaintiff,

v.

MIKE JOHNSON, in his individual and official
capacity as Speaker of the United States House of
Representatives;

DONALD J. TRUMP, in his individual capacity as
former and current President of the United States;

PAM BONDI, in her individual and official
capacity as Attorney General of the United States;

BRENDAN CARR, in his individual and official
capacity as Chairman of the Federal
Communications Commission;

THE UNITED STATES HOUSE OF
REPRESENTATIVES;

ANTHROPIC PBC;

OPENAI, INC.;

APPLE INC.;

COMCAST CABLE COMMUNICATIONS, LLC;

METR (MODEL EVALUATION & THREAT
RESEARCH);

and DOES 1-20, unknown co-conspirators,

Defendants.

Case No. 1:25-cv-02735-ACR

**EXHIBIT ANTHROPIC-2:
CLAUDE CODE REMOVED
FROM PRO PLAN —
ZITRON NEWS ARTICLE
(2026-04-21)**



NEWS

[UPDATED] News: Anthropic (Briefly) Removes Claude Code From \$20-A-Month "Pro" Subscription Plan For New Users

ED ZITRON / APR 21, 2026 / 3 MIN READ

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Executive Summary:

- In the later afternoon of April 21 2026, Anthropic removed access to Claude Code for its \$20-a-month "Pro" Plans on various pricing pages.
 - Current Pro users appeared to still have access via the Claude web app.
 - Claude Code support documents, for a brief period of time, exclusively referred to accessing Claude Code via "your Max Plan," after previously saying you could access "with your Pro or Max Plan."
- On this was raised on Twitter, Anthropic Head of Growth Amol Avasare claimed that this was a "small test of 2% of new prosumer signups."
 - When pressed as to why support documents were changed and why the website consistently showed users that Pro subscribers weren't offered Claude Code, Avasare did not respond.
 - At an unknown time, Anthropic reversed the changes to the website and

support documentation.

- This piece remains as a record of what happened, as I do not believe that this is the last time that Anthropic makes changes in this manner.
 - Per Avasare, "...[Anthropic] made small adjustments along the way (weekly caps, tighter limits at peak), but usage has changed a lot and our current plans weren't built for this." This suggests that changes are to come for all subscription tiers, as he also added that Claude's Max plan was released before Claude Code and Claude Cowork, and "...designed for heavy chat usage, that's it."

The following exists as a record of what happened previously, please see above for the full story.

In developing news, Anthropic appears to have removed access to AI coding tool Claude Code from its \$20-a-month "Pro" accounts. This is likely another cost-cutting move that follows a recent change (per The Information) that forced enterprise users to pay on a per-million-token based rate rather than having rate limits that were, based on researchers' findings, often much higher than the cost of the subscription.

Update: Anthropic's Amol Avasare claims that it is "...running a small test on ~2% of new prosumer signups. Existing Pro and Max subscribers aren't affected." This does not really make sense given the fact that all support documents and the Claude website reflect that Pro users do not have access to Claude Code.

I am waiting for further comment.

Previously, users were able to access Claude using their Pro subscriptions via a command-line interface and both the web and desktop Claude apps. Users were, instead of paying on a per-million-token basis, allowed to use their subscription to access Claude Code, but will likely now have to pay for API access.

Anthropic's Claude Code support documents (as recently as this April 10th archived page) previously read "Using Claude Code with your Pro or Max plan." The page now reads "Using Claude Code with your Max plan."

Pricing on Anthropic's website reflects the removal of Claude Code on both mobile and desktop.



Pro

For everyday productivity

\$17

Per month with annual subscription discount (\$200 billed up front). \$20 if billed monthly.

Try Claude

Everything in Free, plus:

- ✓ More usage*
- ✓ Includes Claude Cowork
- ✓ Access to unlimited projects to organize chats and documents
- ✓ Access to Research
- ✓ Ability to use more Claude models

- ✓ Claude for Excel (beta)
- ✓ Claude for PowerPoint (beta)



Pricing

Explore here ▾

Free

Pro

Max 5x

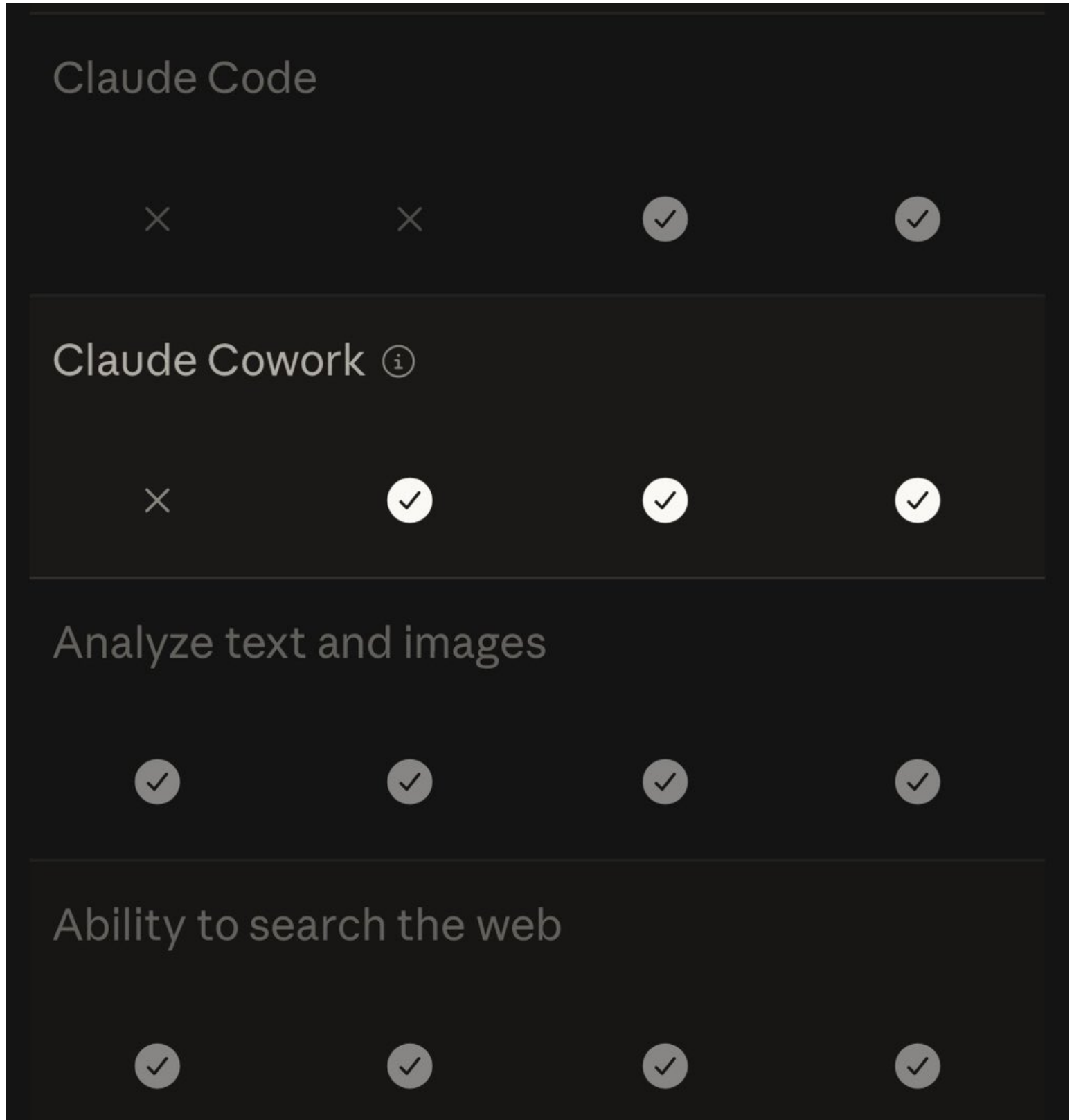
Max 20x

Features and capabilities



Chat on web, iOS, Android and Desktop





Some Pro users report that they are still able to access Claude Code via the web app and Command-Line Interface.

It is unclear at this time whether this change is retroactive or for new Pro subscribers, or

whether Anthropic intends to entirely remove access to Claude Code (without paying for API tokens) from *every* Pro customer.

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I have requested a comment from Anthropic, and will update this piece when I receive it, or if Anthropic confirms this move otherwise.

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It's \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of [NVIDIA](#), [Anthropic and OpenAI's finances](#), and [the AI bubble writ large](#). I recently put out the timely and important [Hater's Guide To The SaaSocalypse](#), another on [How AI Isn't Too Big To Fail](#), a deep (17,500 word) [Hater's Guide To OpenAI](#), and just last week put out the massive [Hater's Guide To Private Credit](#).

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Executive Summary * OpenAI CFO Sarah Friar has, per The Information, said that OpenAI is not ready to go public in

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